

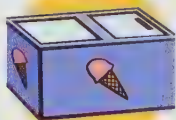
and I don't have to worry about remembering my pan if I take something to a friend's house.

Ice cube trays

This strategy is fantastic for easy once-a-month food prep. Baby food, curry pastes, pizza sauce, and home-made soup stocks are all easily frozen and thawed for use using the ice cube tray strategy. If you only want to buy a half dozen or so, freeze your selected stock, paste, or puree and then empty the cubes into a gallon freezer bag or reusable container.

Freezer(s)

Not all bulk-prep items require a freezer, but many do. If you've already embraced freezer savings as a personal finance strategy, then assembly cooking (at least the freezer variety) will be a quicker transition for you. If you have an upright, great! If not, and a chest freezer is what you've purchased, stay organized and disciplined about the freezer space.



CATEGORIES

While many resources focus on the freezer variety of batch cooking, there are other categories. Here are what I

see as the four main areas, and ideas for putting them to use.

Dry mixes and spice blends

Whether you go with make-ahead bread mixes, DIY spice blends for meat rubs and baking, or like to make your own giant batches of dry ingredient mixes for baking mix, dry soup base, pizza crust, and more, many options are out there for saving money. If you are still saving for a large freezer, this is an excellent OAMC category to start out with.

Canning

Whether you choose recipes suited for the water-bath technique, do your own oven sealing for home-made glazed and roasted nuts, or experiment with more technically advanced pressure-canning recipes, this can save you major cash. It's also another way people without a freezer can participate with advance meal prep. Canning spaghetti sauce instead of freezing is a good example.

Dry ingredient kits

Whether you like the do-ahead kits for Asian coleslaw, small bags of texturized vegetable protein (TVP) and taco seasoning, brown-bag-grab-and-take lunch snacks, or make-your-own hamburger and tuna helper kits, dry ingredient make-aheads also